

Potential Client Shortlist & Strategic Engagement Analysis for
Grant Thornton China



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Why Potential Clients Matter for Grant Thornton China

- **Strengthens Long-Term Growth :** Targeting the right clients builds a sustainable pipeline, not just one-time projects.
- **Matches Expertise With Real Needs:** Helps GT deliver high-value forensic services where risks, compliance issues, and oversight pressures are highest.
- **Improves Resource Allocation:** Teams can focus time and effort on clients with the strongest fit and highest engagement potential.
- **Enhances Relationship Building:** Understanding client motivations and challenges creates trust and increases repeat engagement.
- **Boosts Market Positioning:** Working with influential MNCs, PE firms, and law firms elevates GT's visibility in China's competitive advisory landscape.
- **Drives Better Outcomes for Both Sides:** The right match ensures smoother collaboration, stronger retention, and impactful results.



Stakeholder Engagement Approach For Grant Thornton



● Why Strategic Engagement Analysis Matters

- **Helps Identify the Right Opportunities:** Ensures GT invests in clients who actually need forensic, compliance, or investigative support.
- **Clarifies Client Priorities & Motivations:** Understanding what each client values (risk mitigation, deal confidence, regulatory clarity) improves GT's approach.
- **Supports Tailored Communication:** Engagement analysis allows GT to speak the client's language—whether legal precision, investor assurance, or operational stability.
- **Strengthens Relationship Building:** By mapping power/interest levels, GT can build meaningful, long-term partnerships with key decision-makers.
- **Improves Win Probability:** A strategic view helps GT deliver the right service at the right moment, increasing conversion and retention.
- **Reduces Resource Wastage:** Focuses time and effort only on clients where impact and engagement likelihood are high.

● How It Matters

Strategic Engagement Analysis matters because it allows Grant Thornton to focus on clients who truly need its forensic and advisory services, understand their priorities, and communicate in ways that resonate with their goals. By mapping client influence, interest, and risk exposure, GT can tailor its approach, strengthen long-term relationships, improve conversion chances, and ensure resources are used efficiently on high-impact opportunities.

Our 4 Week-wise Internship Journey Overview

WEEK-1

Potential Client Research & Identification

- Conducted secondary research to shortlist credible MNCs, PE firms, and law firms.
- Verified presence in Beijing/Shanghai and aligned with GT China's target profile.

WEEK-2

Use Case Mapping & Retention Strategy

- Mapped GT China's forensic advisory services to client needs.
- Designed tailored retention strategies for long-term engagement.

WEEK-3

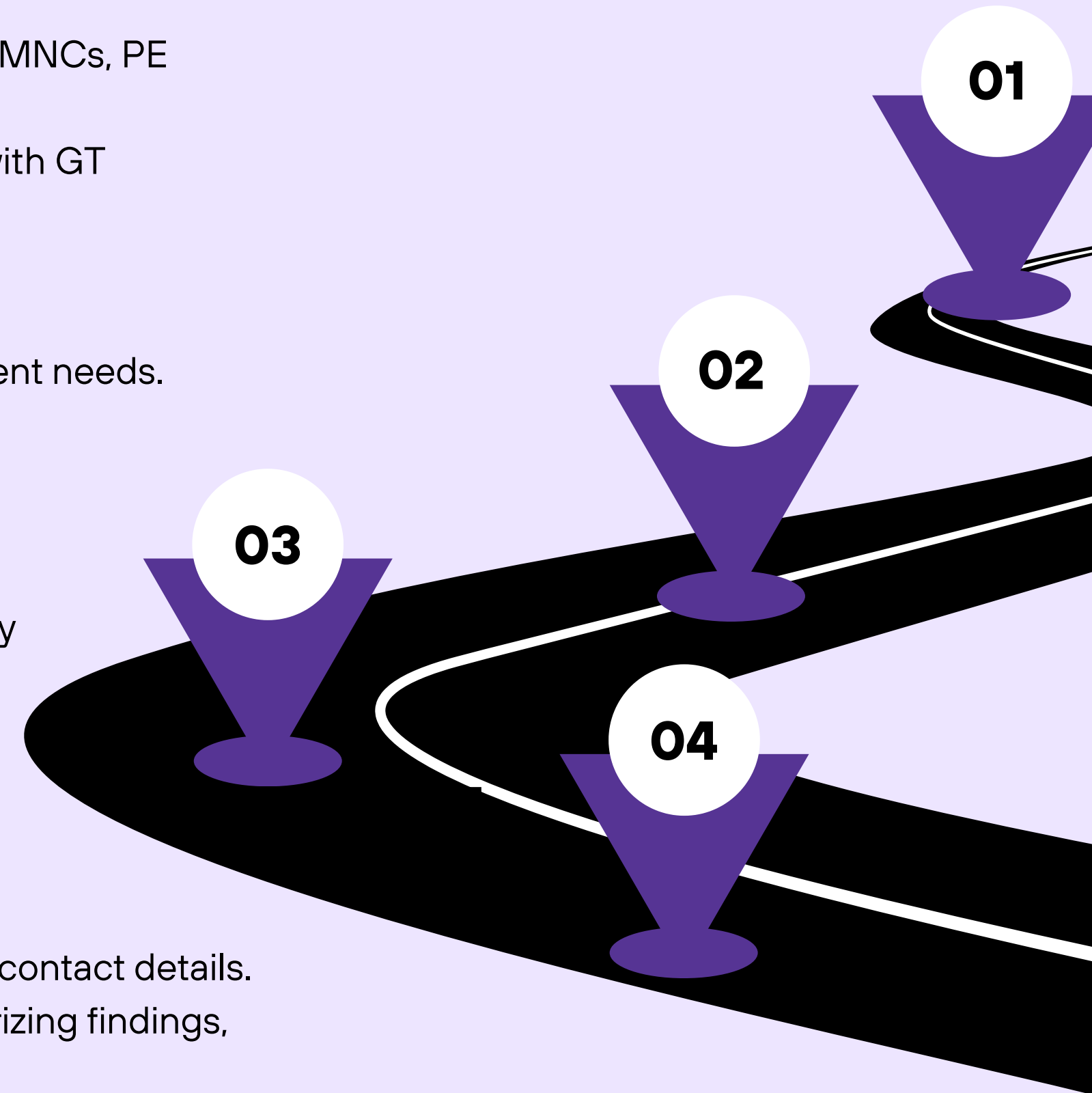
Client Relevance & Power/Interest Evaluation

- Selected clients based on relevance metrics: industry risk, compliance pressure, global footprint, and operational complexity.
- Placed potential clients on a power/interest grid to prioritize engagement.

WEEK-4

Final Database & Virtual Presentation

- Curated a final shortlist of 35+ potential clients with contact details.
- Recorded and shared a virtual presentation summarizing findings, use cases, and engagement strategies.



Key Relevance Metrics for Grant Thornton China

- **Industry Risk Exposure:** Clients in high-risk sectors (finance, tech, healthcare) need robust forensic support.
- **China Operational Complexity:** Multijurisdictional operations increase compliance and investigation needs.
- **Compliance Pressure Level:** Clients under strict regulatory scrutiny require continuous advisory and monitoring.
- **Presence in Beijing/Shanghai:** Local offices ensure relevance and accessibility for GT China services.
- **Global Footprint:** Multinational operations demand alignment with both local and international compliance standards.
- **Strategic Expansion & Regulatory Scrutiny:** Growing firms or those in regulated markets face higher risks, needing proactive engagement.
- **Suitability for Long-Term Engagements:** Clients with recurring advisory requirements create sustainable partnerships.

These metrics help prioritize clients who benefit most from GT China's forensic advisory expertise.

Industry Risk

High-risk sectors need strong forensic support.



China Operations

Complex, multi-location operations increase compliance needs



Regulatory Pressure

Strict oversight requires ongoing advisory.



Local Presence

Beijing / Shanghai offices ensure accessibility.



Global Footprint

Aligns local and international compliance.



Growth & Scrutiny

Expanding or regulated firms face higher risks.



Long-Term Fit

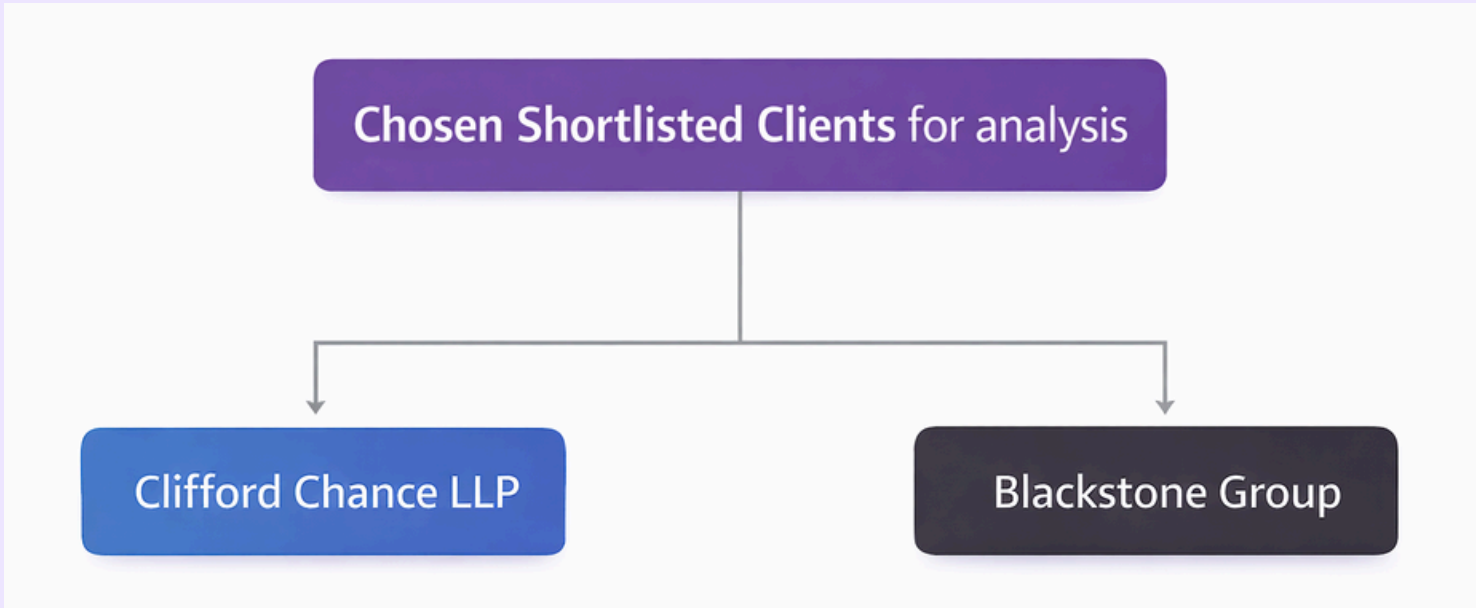
Recurring advisory needs support sustainable partnerships.

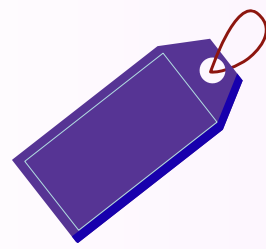


Client Selection Methodology & Shortlist Overview

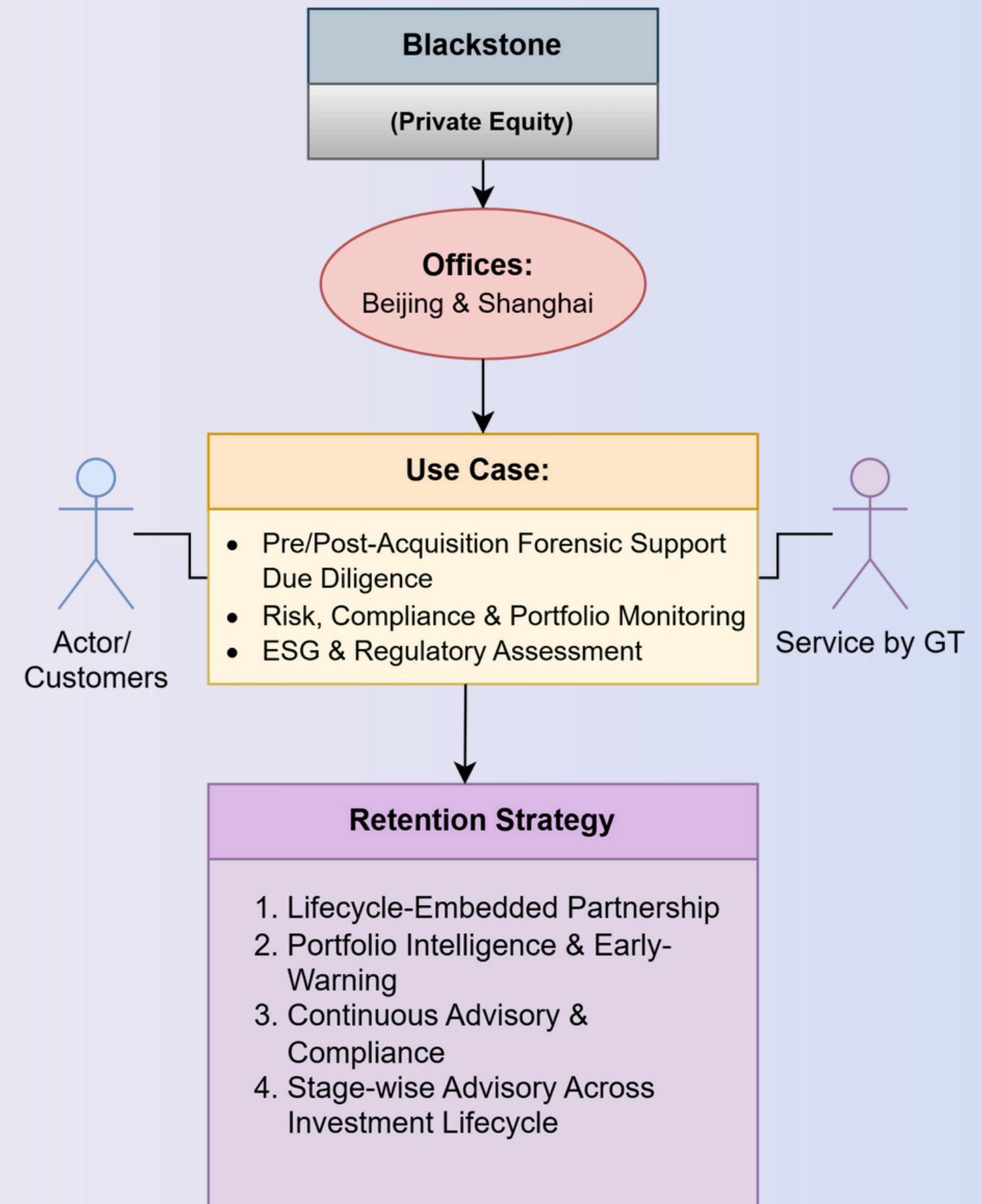
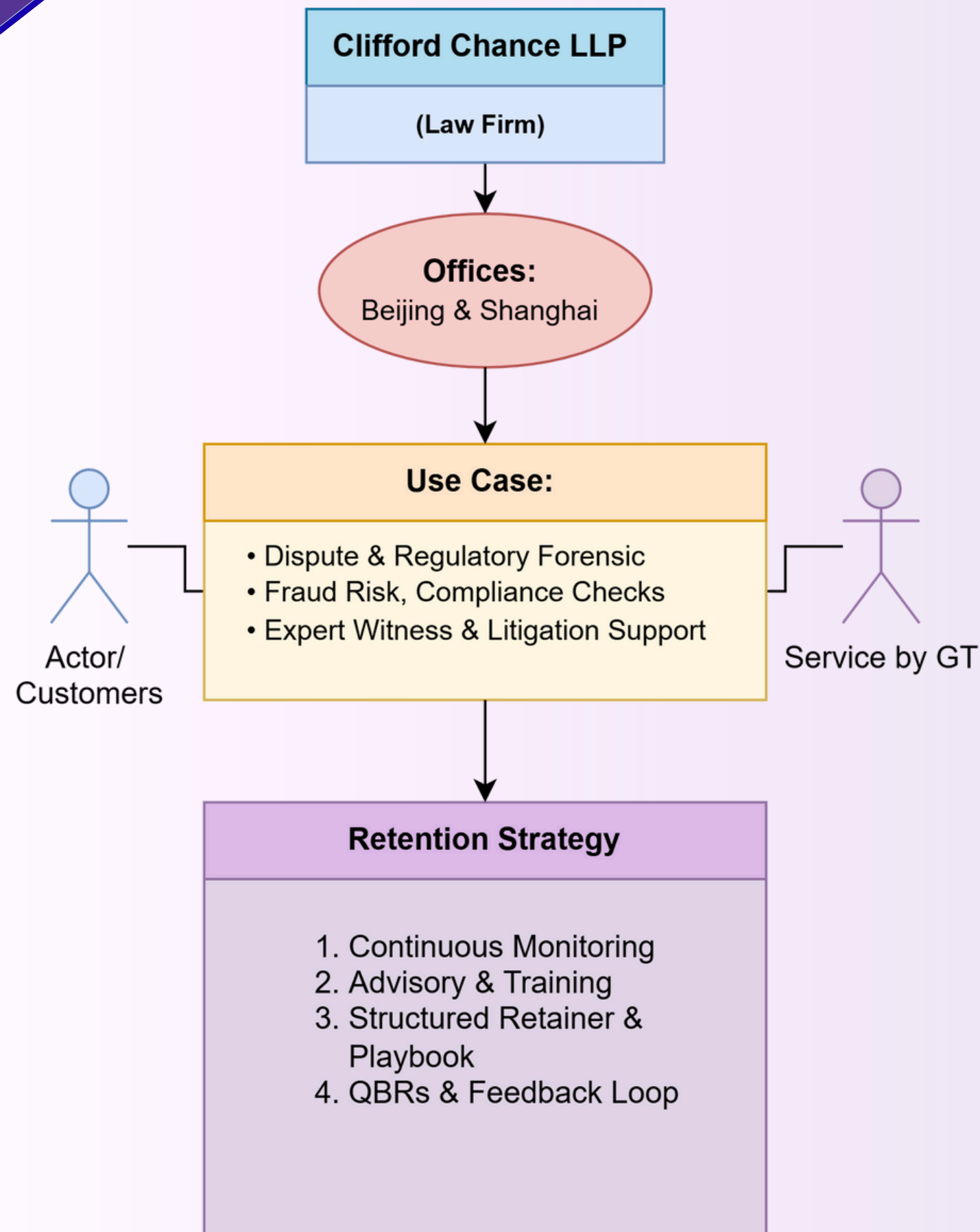


We followed a structured, criteria-based approach to build a strong shortlist of potential clients for Grant Thornton China. Our selection included a minimum of 15 multinational corporations and PE/VC firms, along with 20 international law firms, all required to have an operational presence in Beijing or Shanghai. For each entity, we compiled a detailed table covering the company or firm name, website, industry type, China location, key partner or decision-maker, contact information, and a clear justification for why they align with Grant Thornton's forensic advisory services. We evaluated every candidate using relevance metrics such as regulatory exposure, China operational complexity, compliance pressure, global footprint, and potential for long-term engagement. From this structured shortlist, we selected two high-impact clients—Clifford Chance LLP and Blackstone Group—for deeper analysis, use-case development, retention strategy and strategic recommendations tailored to Grant Thornton's forensic practice.

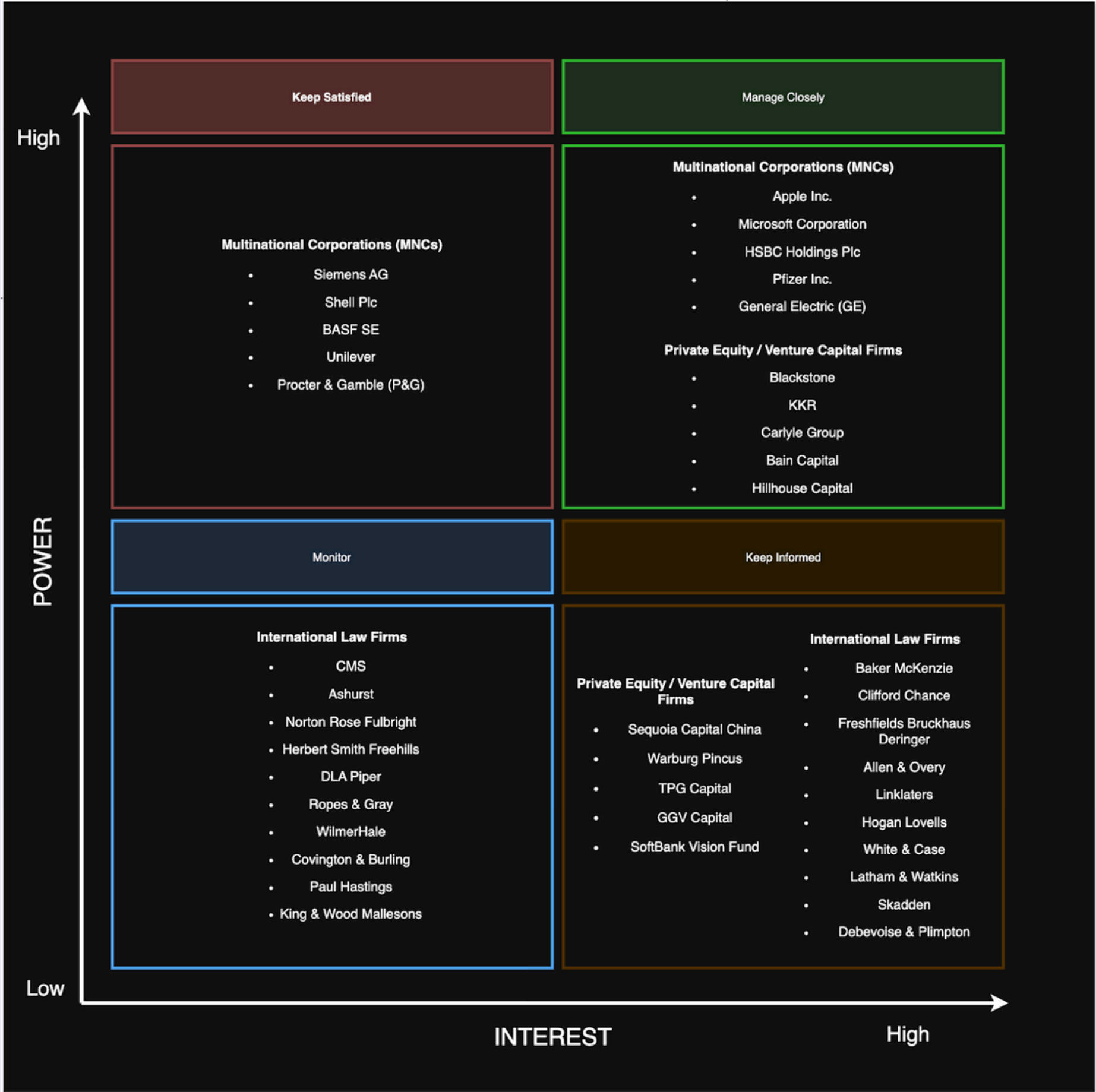




Selected Clients: Use Case Analysis & Retention Overview



Power/Interest Grid Overview For Grant Thornton China



How We Evaluated the Shortlisted Clients

We assessed each client based on two dimensions:

- **Power** — their ability to approve, influence, or shape forensic engagements.
- **Interest** — their need for GT’s forensic, compliance, and investigation services.

Power indicators we evaluated:

- Decision-making authority over advisory work
- Size and financial influence
- Control over budgets and external advisors
- Ability to initiate multi-service, long-term engagements

Interest indicators we evaluated:

- Exposure to compliance, fraud, and regulatory risks in China
- Need for investigations, dispute support, M&A forensics
- Cross-border transactions and recurring advisory demands

We categorised all clients into four quadrants:

High Power – High Interest: Priority targets, manage closely

High Power – Low Interest: Keep satisfied for future opportunities

Low Power – High Interest: Keep informed & build referral partnerships

Low Power – Low Interest: Monitor with minimal engagement

Our key insight:

Large MNCs & PE firms sit in the high-priority quadrant, while law firms act as strategic referral partners that strengthen GT’s pipeline.

Key Insights & Recommendations For Grant Thornton

1. Why These Clients Are Most Desirable for GT

- High regulatory exposure in China → consistent forensic needs
- Complex cross-border operations → high reliance on expert advisory
- Strong potential for repeat business and long-term strategic partnerships
- Influence in their respective sectors ensures visibility and credibility for GT

2. Engagement Opportunities

- Analyzed Clifford Chance: Litigation support, expert witness collaboration, joint forensic-legal projects
- Analyzed Blackstone: Pre/post-acquisition due diligence, portfolio monitoring, ESG & compliance advisory
- Potential for hybrid retainer models and subscription-based continuous services

3. Expansion & Advisory Potential

- Cross-selling forensic, compliance, digital forensics, and risk advisory services
- Developing lifecycle-based engagement for PE clients (pre-deal, post-deal, exit)
- Strategic advisory in regulatory intelligence, training, and operational risk management

4. Risk Factors & Mitigation Notes

- **Client-side:** Dynamic regulatory changes, complex multi-jurisdictional requirements → mitigate with proactive monitoring and updates
- **Operational:** Resource allocation, knowledge transfer → mitigate via structured onboarding, playbooks, and dashboards
- **Strategic:** Dependency on global operations and sensitive information → mitigate with confidentiality protocols and secure communication channels



Our Acknowledgement & Conclusion

We, the team, successfully completed the 4-week virtual internship with Grant Thornton, gaining hands-on experience in:

- Identifying and shortlisting potential clients across MNCs, PE/VC firms, and international law firms
- Applying relevance metrics and power-interest analysis to prioritize engagement strategies
- Conducting use-case analysis and designing retention strategies for high-value clients
- Preparing a comprehensive database and delivering a professional virtual presentation

This internship strengthened our understanding of forensic advisory, strategic client engagement, and cross-border compliance considerations.

We sincerely are thankful to **Excelerate** platform, Our team & our associates for providing this invaluable opportunity to learn, apply our skills in a real-world context, and enhance our professional capabilities.

Thank You

